

MIL-ECHO Offline Game: Teacher's Manual

Welcome to the **MIL-ECHO (Media and Information Literacy) Offline Game**. This manual provides a structured framework for educators, facilitators, and trainers to seamlessly integrate this card-based learning experience into a classroom or workshop setting.

1. Overview

The MIL-ECHO offline card game is an interactive, discussion-based activity designed to teach Media and Information Literacy. By simulating the spread of information, misinformation, deepfakes, and scams, players learn how to critically evaluate sources, understand psychological triggers that make fake news go viral, and build "resilience" against manipulation.

The game revolves around two core metrics:

Clout: The temptation to share sensational, often fake, content to gain social media popularity.

Resilience: The critical thinking skills required to stop the spread of misinformation by verifying sources and understanding biases.

2. Learning Objectives

By playing this game, students will:

- 1. Identify Misinformation:** Distinguish between factual news, half-truths, fabricated content, phishing scams, and deepfakes.
- 2. Analyze Emotional Triggers:** Recognize how content uses fear, greed, tribalism, and confirmation bias to manipulate behavior.
- 3. Understand Consequences:** See the real-world impact of viral misinformation (e.g., vaccine hesitancy, market crashes, community violence).
- 4. Develop Critical Thinking:** Use the "Socratic Method" to question the creator, intent, and evidence behind a headline before "sharing" it.

3. Game Components

The printable deck contains various scenario cards across 5 domains (Health, Politics, Technology, Social/Community, Finance). Each card represents a piece of content spreading online and features:

Headline / Claim: The core message of the content.

Card Type & Category: e.g., Misinformation, Deepfake, Scam, Prejudice, Opinion.

Truth Status: True, Misleading, or Fake.

Clout Risk & Resilience Impact: The point values associated with the card.

Socratic Prompt: A critical question to evaluate the card's validity (e.g., "What 1 primary source verifies this?").

Behind the scenes (for the teacher's reference), each card has deep AI analysis attached, explaining the creator's motive, the context, the bias, and the real-world consequences.

4. Setup & Preparation

Print and Cut: Download and print the generated PDF card decks (`teacher\_manual.pdf` and `mil\_echo\_offline\_cards.pdf`). Cut out the cards.

Group Size: Divide the class into small groups of 4-6 students.

Roles: Assign one student in each group as the "Fact-Checker" (this role can rotate each round), while the others are "Social Media Users".

Time Required: 30-45 minutes for gameplay, followed by 15-20 minutes of debriefing.

5. How to Play (Core Mechanics)

Goal

To build the highest **Resilience Score** as a team by successfully identifying and stopping misinformation, while avoiding the temptation of reckless **Clout**.

Turn Structure

1. **Draw a Card:** The active player draws a card from the center deck and reads the **Headline** and **Source** out loud to the group.

2. **The Dilemma (Share or Verify):**

The player can choose to **"Share"** the card to gain immediate **Clout Points** (simulating viral engagement). However, if the card is fake, they suffer a severe **Chaos/Resilience Penalty**.

Or, the player can choose to **"Verify"** the card by asking the **Socratic Prompt** on the card.

3. **Group Discussion:** If the player chooses to Verify, the group discusses the headline. They must identify: What emotional trigger is this exploiting? (e.g., Fear, Greed, Us vs. Them)

Is it likely True, Misleading, or Fake?

4. **The Reveal:** The Fact-Checker reveals the true nature of the card (its Truth Status and Real-World Impact).

5. **Scoring:**

If the group correctly identifies misinformation and chooses not to share it, they earn **Resilience Points**.

If they share fake news, the group loses Resilience and gains Chaos.

6. **Rotate:** The next player draws a card.

6. Socratic Prompts & AI Analysis (Teacher's Guide)

When students struggle to verify a card, guide them using these framework questions based on the game's AI Analysis engine:

Creator: Who made this? What is their business model or political agenda?

Content: Is this scientifically or logically possible? Does it mix real facts with fake context?

Context: Why is this being shared *now*? (e.g., during an election, a pandemic, a market panic).

Bias: Who is the target audience? Does this validate a specific community's prejudices (Red vs. Blue community)?

7. Post-Game Debriefing

After the gameplay concludes, hold a classroom discussion using the following prompts:

1. Which headline was the hardest to identify as fake, and why?

2. How did it feel when you were tempted by the "Clout Reward" to share something sensational?

3. What were the most common emotional triggers used in the fake cards? (Reflect on fear-mongering and tribal identity).

4. How can we apply the "Resilience" we practiced in this game to our real-life social media feeds?

Note: This manual is designed to be used alongside the printed offline decks. The digital JSON database contains extended context (Real-World Consequences and Educational Notes) which the teacher can use as a reference sheet during the debriefing phase.

Teacher's Ledger

This ledger contains the answers and Socratic prompts for each card in the offline deck, referenced by Card ID.

[card-001] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-002] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-003] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-004] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-005] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-006] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-007] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-008] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-009] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-010] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-011] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-012] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-013] Verdict: Misleading | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-014] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-015] Verdict: Misleading | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-016] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-017] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-018] Verdict: Misleading | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-019] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-020] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-021] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-022] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-023] Verdict: Misleading | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-024] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-025] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-026] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-027] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-028] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-029] Verdict: Misleading | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-030] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-031] Verdict: Misleading | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-032] Verdict: Fake | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-033] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-034] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-035] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-036] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-037] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-038] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-039] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-040] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-041] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-042] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-043] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-044] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-045] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-046] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-047] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-048] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-049] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-050] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-051] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-052] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-053] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown

Prompt: N/A

[card-054] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A

[card-055] Verdict: Real | Resilience: +0 | Clout Risk: Unknown
Prompt: N/A